



No Firefox ??

Mozilla has announced that it is getting rid of version numbers for its Firefox web browser
<http://bit.ly/ofmK5M>

Touchy feely!

Leeds University has tried to simulate pressure remotely in a bid to create a device to help doctors treat cancer <http://bbc.in/nOd7id>

respectively. Both these apps reside in the Dock next to the Finder.

Mission Control is a combination of Exposé, Dashboard and Spaces with some fresh features all rolled into one. At the top, you see a row of windows (if you have them open) which essentially is the old Spaces. To add a new Space, just click on the top-right corner; every full-screen app is shown as a Space. Below the top row you have the central, Exposé-like section where you see all open windows grouped by their app. In the bottom, you see the ever-present Dock with a spotlight under the apps that are open and highlighted in Mission Control. Mission Control is a lot of fun and is actually pretty useful.

Launchpad is instantly familiar to anyone who has used iOS before. It's a gesture-enabled app launcher with the ability to group apps together as folders, rename them, etc. – basically everything you thought you can do with apps on iOS' home screen. It instantly shows all the software available on your Mac in a tiled icon layout – a little different from the stacked layout when you click on Applications in Dock. Although it looks pretty, Launchpad is a little difficult to use on the iMac. It feels more convenient and natural to launch on the trackpad of a MacBook. Nevertheless, this is a handy new addition to OS X.

Interesting apps and features

While it's impossible to cover every small feature and app within the confines of this article, we'll list some interesting ones nonetheless.

Auto Save and Resume: Apps that support Auto Save (Preview, iWork, and TextEdit) can automatically save changes to your document as you work; think Google Docs. All changes are saved in the background and you can work without any distraction of pauses or progress bars. What's more, Auto Save in OS X Lion adds the changes directly into the file so there's only one copy



Lion lets you restore your last session.

of the document on your Mac. Definitely a useful addition.

Resume is one useful feature, letting you save and restore your session “as it was” even after you shut down or restart your Mac. Lion saves a snapshot of your system as it logs off and reloads the instance when you log back in, resuming it in the exact same state as you last closed it. Apps, documents, windows, processes...everything is restored. Now you don't have to fret about closing your work. This is a great feature if you want to instantly restart your Mac to finish installing a new app. Hopefully, third-party apps will exploit it to the fullest.

AirDrop: A new but limited feature, AirDrop lets you easily share files between Macs within close physical proximity of each other; works great at an office environment or home with multiple Mac users. It requires zero setup, no configuring and is extremely simple to take advantage of. Click on AirDrop on the left sidebar of your Finder window to see a radar-like image with your own

Mac stationed at the bottom. If someone is accessing their AirDrop window within a range of ten metre, they pop onto your AirDrop radar (and vice versa). To share files just drag and drop on the Mac icon within AirDrop, that's it. Communication is secure and peer-to-peer.

iCal: As you can guess, the UI is heavily influenced by the Calendar app on the iPad. Even though we like the leather-clad, hand-sewn, minimal look of the iCal in Lion, we don't like the disappearance of the extremely useful left-hand column (present in the older iCal) which would allow quick launch and flipping through multiple calendars.

The tab views at the top, that is Day, Week, Month and Year are identical to the iPad Calendar app and useful. The Quick Add feature for instantly adding a calendar event is nice and helpful, too.

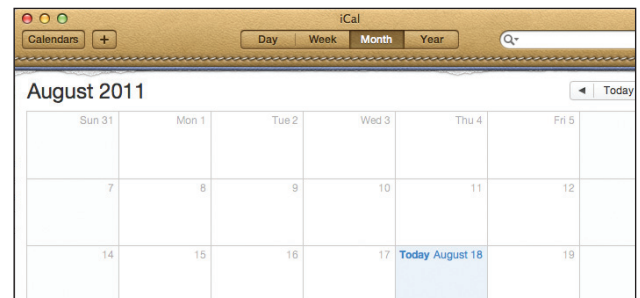


Sharing between two Macs couldn't be more simpler

Mail: The new email app's interface in Mac OS X Lion is inspired from... yes, you guessed it right, iOS's email app. It has a three-pane layout: the left pane has all your mailbox-related features like inbox, drafts, starred, etc; emails from the account are shown in the middle pane, arranged as per date, flags, etc; and the third, right-most pane displays the email content and conversation thread. The new Mail in OS X Lion has the ability to preview an email under its header, just like in iOS and the iPad. We don't mind the iOS-ification of the Mail app in Lion, it actually works out pretty well.

End of an era

With all new things, there comes an inevitable end to that which is old,



Lion's new calendar app is influenced by its iOS counterpart

whether we like it or not. With OS X Lion, Apple has officially discontinued support for Rosetta which used to allow running apps written for older PowerPC on newer Intel-architecture Macs.

Apple has inconspicuously removed support for Front Row, Mac's media centre software. It has disappointed fans and bewildered users, especially because the newer Lion is more than capable of handling the app.

Last few words

Lion is no doubt a major step forward for Apple's Mac OS X and only time will tell whether Apple's philosophy of merging iOS with OS X will be a hit or miss. As things stand right now, Mac users are in a transition phase with Lion, and for \$29.99 (₹1,369) you can see what all the fuss is about. **d**